

PART 1 – Testing Framework (Reusable)

Scale SD — Ad Testing & Launch Framework

The repeatable system for how Scale SD launches, tests, kills, scales, and iterates ads. Built once. Used every shoot. No re-inventing. Version: 1.0 — locked 2026-05-06.

Core principles

- 1. **Every ad is a test.** No ad ships without a hypothesis and a kill threshold.
- 2. **Budget is a constraint, not a target.** \$1k/mo means we test cheap, decide fast.
- 3. **Naming is destiny.** Bad naming = no learning. Every ad has a parsable name.
- 4. **Decisions on schedule.** Day 3 review. Day 7 review. Day 14 review. Not when you feel like it.
- 5. **The bible is the source of truth.** Every angle, hook, and avatar pulls from `Scale_SD_Creative_Bible.xlsx`.

The 3 funnel tracks

Track	Mechanism	When to use	Spark validation
A — Lead Form	Meta on-platform form, 3 questions. Auto-routes to GHL → SMS to Dani's phone.	Volume play. Cold audience. Maximum leads, qualify after.	Spark's recent ads (May 2026) all switched to this.
B — Video LP	Pre-qualification video on landing page → 3-question form → calendar booking. Velocity-style.	Quality play. Higher cost-per-lead, higher show rate, higher close rate. Pre-qualifies.	Velocity's \$70k/mo system.
C — DM Funnel	Comment "SCALE" or DM "SCALE" → IG keyword auto-DM → 1-on-1 conversation → Calendly.	Lowest budget. Relationship-build. Best ROI when budget is small and salesperson is available.	Spark's 140-145 day longest-runners are this format.

Default split for any new shoot: - 40% Track A (form) — most volume, lowest CPL benchmark - 30% Track B (video LP) — quality / pre-qualification test - 30% Track C (DM) — relationship + low-friction test

After 14 days of data, reweight to the winner. After 30 days of data, lock the dominant track.

Naming convention (LOCKED)

Every campaign, ad set, and ad name follows this exact format:

SCALE_{YYYY-MM-DD}_{TRACK}_{TRADE}_{ANGLE}_{HOOK#}_{LENGTH}_v{N}

Example:

SCALE_2026-05-08_A_GC_PickingJobs_H41_15s_v1
SCALE_2026-05-08_C_GC_BurnedBob_H49_30s_v1
SCALE_2026-05-08_B_Pool_Urgency_H72_45s_v1

Slug	What it means	Source
SCALE	Brand prefix	Always
YYYY-MM-DD	Launch date	Day campaign goes live
TRACK	A / B / C	Funnel track (above)
TRADE	GC / Pool / HVAC / Roof / Plumb / Win / Land / All	Avatar from Sheet 2
ANGLE	PickingJobs / BurnedBob / HyperLocal / Mechanism / Urgency / Story / Confession / Education	Sheet 5
HOOK#	H1-H100	Hook reference number from Sheet 7
LENGTH	5s / 15s / 30s / 45s / 60s	Ad duration
v{N}	Version	v1 = first cut, v2 = iteration after kill/edit

Why this matters: when you pull a Meta report 6 months from now, you can filter by any slug to learn what worked. "Show me every GC PickingJobs angle across all shoots" is a one-line filter.

Test cell taxonomy

Every launch is a 5-dimension matrix. We never fire an ad without specifying all 5.

Dimension	Options
Trade	GC / Pool / HVAC / Roof / Plumb / Win / Land / All-Trades
Angle	Problem / Mechanism / Identity / Story / Social Proof / Urgency / Risk Reversal / Education
Format	Talking Head / UGC / B-Roll+VO / Static / Carousel / Reels
Length	5s / 15s / 30s / 45s / 60s
Track	A (form) / B (video LP) / C (DM)

Rule of 1: when running A/B tests, hold 4 of 5 dimensions constant. Vary only ONE. Otherwise you can't attribute the win.

Rule of 6: at any one time, never run more than 6 active ads per ad account. Past 6, you can't see signal in the noise on \$50/day.

The 4-phase launch protocol (every shoot uses this)

Phase 1 — POST-SHOOT (Days 0-2: edit + setup)

Day	Action	Owner
0 (shoot day)	Raw to Drive /SCALE/Ads/{date}-{subject}/raw/ . Slack ping in #all-tools .	Dani
1 (edit day)	Editor cuts 6-8 versions matching shoot brief. Each cut named per convention.	Editor
1-2	Ad accounts confirmed clean. Pixel verified firing. Lead form built (3 Qs). DM automation built (if Track C).	Ashen
2	Final review by Dani. Approve/edit each cut. Move to /SCALE/Ads/{date}-{subject}/approved/ .	Dani

Hard rule: nothing goes live without Dani's written approval per cut.

Phase 2 — LAUNCH (Day 3: go live)

Action	Detail
Build campaign in Meta Ads Manager	Campaign name = SCALE_{date}_{shoot-slug}_LaunchWeek
Build campaign in TikTok Ads Manager (if Spanish)	Same naming
Set ad sets per Track (A, B, C)	One ad set per track
Place 4-6 ads inside each ad set (max 6 per Rule of 6)	Each named per convention
Daily budget: \$50/day total, split per Track default	\$20 A / \$15 B / \$15 C
Audience: SD County, 30-mile radius from city center, age 30-60, contractor + home-services interests, \$200k+ HHI proxy	Locked across all shoots — only test creative, not audience
Pixel + GHL routing verified BEFORE pressing go live	Test one form submission end-to-end
Slack post in #all-tools : 🚀 Launch live. {N} ads, 3 tracks, \$50/day. Day 3 review on calendar."	Ashen

Phase 3 — REVIEW (Days 6, 9, 16, 23, 30)

Three review cadences, three different decisions.

Day 3 review (early signal — kill the worst)

- Pull report: spend, impressions, CTR, CPL per ad
- **Kill rule:** any ad with $\text{CPL} > \$50$ OR $\text{CTR} < 0.5\%$ on \$20+ spent → pause it
- **Hypothesis check:** is one Track outperforming? Note in launch doc.
- Reallocate killed budget to top performer

Day 7 review (real signal — scale the best)

- Same metrics, larger sample
- **Scale rule:** any ad with $\text{CPL} < \$15$ AND ≥ 7 leads → increase budget to \$40/day
- **Kill rule:** any ad with $\text{CPL} > \$35$ OR fewer than 3 leads on \$50+ spend → pause
- **Iterate rule:** any ad with promising CTR (1.5%+) but high CPL → swap hook only, ship as v2

Day 14 review (track decision)

- Compare Track A vs B vs C lead-to-call conversion rates
- **Reweight rule:** dominant track gets 60% of budget. Second-best gets 30%. Third gets 10%.
- Document in launch debrief

Day 30 review (campaign close)

- Calculate: total spend, total leads, blended CPL, calls booked, deals closed, MRR generated
- Mark winners for next-shoot inspiration
- Mark losers for never-do-again list
- Update `Scale_SD_Creative_Bible.xlsx` : any new hook that won goes into Sheet 7 with awareness stage + MS reference

Decision rules — kill / scale / iterate

Metric on \$20+ spend	Action
$\text{CPL} < \$15$	SCALE to \$40/day
$\text{CPL } \$15\text{--}\25	Hold, monitor
$\text{CPL } \$25\text{--}\35	Iterate (swap hook)
$\text{CPL } \$35\text{--}\50	Kill at Day 7 if no improvement
$\text{CPL} > \$50$ at Day 3	KILL immediately
$\text{CTR} < 0.5\%$ on \$20 spent	KILL immediately
$\text{CTR } 1.5\%+$ but $\text{CPL} > \$35$	Iterate (hook is working, body or CTA is breaking)
7+ leads in first 7 days	SCALE

These thresholds are San Diego contractor benchmarks. Update quarterly based on accumulated data.

Per-launch documentation

Every launch creates a folder: `ads-os/launches/{YYYY-MM-DD}-launch-{N}/`

Required files: - `plan.md` — pre-launch (audience, ad list, budgets, hypotheses) - `_daily-log.md` — every review day's notes (Day 3, 7, 14, 30) - `_debrief.md` — written post Day 30. Top 3 wins, top 3 losses, top 3 learnings, what to test next. - `screenshots/` — pixel-fire confirmation, ad-set screenshots, Meta Lead Form preview, GHL pipeline view

Without all four, the launch is not "complete." Don't archive until done.

Budget envelope (locked from Fathom 2026-05-05 strategy call)

Bucket	Monthly	Daily
Total ad spend	\$1,000	\$50
Meta (English-led)	\$600	\$20 (Track A) + \$15 (Track B) + \$5 (Track C)
TikTok (Spanish-led, when launched)	\$400	\$13 (varies, EN testing first)

Scaling rule: the \$1k/mo cap holds for 12 weeks. After the first booked client from ads, scale ad spend to 8% of new MRR.

What we test in cycle 1 (the FIRST shoot's purpose)

The first shoot establishes baselines. We're not optimizing yet. We're learning:

1. **Which Track converts in our market** — A, B, or C?
2. **Which Trade has lowest CPL** — GC, Pool, or generic?
3. **Which Angle resonates** — Story, Confession, Hyper-Local, or Mechanism?
4. **Which Format wins** — talking head, UGC dialogue, B-roll, or static?
5. **Which Length wins** — 5s, 15s, 30s, 45s?

After cycle 1 (30 days), we know the answer to 3-4 of these. Cycle 2 doubles down on what worked.

Library evolution

After every launch debrief:

- Winning hooks → into Sheet 7 of the Bible (with stage + MS reference + creator's slug)
- Winning angles → into Sheet 5 of the Bible (with new brand example)
- Winning customer language → into Sheet 11 (verbatim from form responses)
- New objections from form responses → into Sheet 12 with crushers
- Killed-ads' lessons → into `_debrief.md` , never re-tested without a hypothesis change

The Bible gets smarter every cycle. By cycle 4 it's a moat.

Roles per launch

Person	Job
Dani	Approve cuts, own client communication, monitor inbound calls
Peter	Creative lead, on-camera, weekly review participant
Ashen	Build campaigns, run reviews, decide kill/scale/iterate, document
Tad	Static-format ads, organic repurposing
Editor	48-hour cut turnaround per shoot

Hard rules

- No ad goes live without a kill threshold.
- No ad goes live without a campaign tag in our naming convention.
- No campaign runs past Day 7 without a documented review.
- No ad uses an unverified specific dollar claim.
- No campaign exceeds 6 active ads per ad account.
- No funnel ships without a working pixel + GHL routing test.
- All proof claims must trace to Sheet 10 of the Bible.

Update log

- 2026-05-06: Initial framework. v1.0. Locked from Fathom call + Spark Manus deep-dive + Bible build.

PART 2 — Launch 1 Specific Plan

LAUNCH 1 — 2026-05-08 (Friday)

First Scale SD Self-Promo Campaign

Source shoot: 2026-05-06 Victor / VIP General Contractor (Vista CA) Total budget: \$1,000/month, \$50/day Goal: establish baseline data on Track / Trade / Angle / Format / Length Status: PRE-LAUNCH

The 6 ads at launch

Selected from creative-library/2026-05-05-spark-batch/ + new cuts from Victor shoot. Held constant: Audience, Geography, Budget per Track. Variables: Angle, Format, Length.

#	Ad name	Angle	Format	Length	Track
1	SCALE_2026-05-08_C_GC_PickingJobs_H41_15s_v1	Story	UGC dialogue	15s	C (DM)
2	SCALE_2026-05-08_A_GC_HyperLocal_H22_30s_v1	Identity (Vista)	Talking Head	30s	A (form)
3	SCALE_2026-05-08_B_GC_BurnedBob_H49_45s_v1	Confession	Talking Head	45s	B (video LP)
4	SCALE_2026-05-08_A_GC_Mechanism_H17_30s_v1	Mechanism	B-Roll + VO	30s	A (form)
5	SCALE_2026-05-08_C_GC_TooBusy_H42_5s_v1	Story (anchor)	UGC	5s	C (DM)
6	SCALE_2026-05-08_A_All_Static_H92_static_v1	Contrarian	Static	n/a	A (form)

Cut sources: Cuts 1, 5 from Victor+Peter conversational (Block 2 of shoot brief). Cut 2 from hyper-local talking head (Block 4). Cut 3 from Peter solo confession (Block 5). Cut 4 from job-site walkthrough (Block 7). Cut 6 from Tad static design.

Hypotheses

Each ad ships with one testable hypothesis.

#	Hypothesis	Success metric (Day 7)
1	Cesar's 145-day winner format works in our market when adapted to GC + DM funnel	CPL < \$15 + 7+ leads
2	Hyper-local "Vista" framing beats generic "San Diego" by 25%+ on CTR	CTR > 2.5%
3	Burned-Bob confession angle pre-qualifies high-intent leads (lower volume, higher quality)	CPL \$20-\$30, ≥40% form-completion rate
4	Mechanism reveal works on solution-aware audience without on-camera talent	CPL < \$20
5	5-second teaser at \$5/day delivers more impressions than longer cuts at same spend	4x impression count of #1
6	Static beats video on CPL even though video wins on CTR	CPL beats avg of 1-5 by 20%+

Audience (LOCKED across all 6 ads)

Why locked: we're testing creative, not audience. Audience changes only after Cycle 1 debrief.

Setting	Value
Location	San Diego County
Geo radius	30 miles from San Diego city center, includes Vista, Carlsbad, Oceanside, La Mesa, Chula Vista, El Cajon, Escondido
Age	30-60
Gender	All
Languages	English
Detailed interests	"General Contractor" + "Construction" + "Remodeling" + "Home Improvement" + "Small Business Owners"
Income proxy	\$200k+ HHI (Meta's "top 10% household income" segment)
Excluded	Already-engaged ScaleHere followers (warm audience handled separately)

Budget split (Day 1 default, reweight after Day 14)

Track	Daily	Allocated to	Rationale
A — Lead Form	\$20	Cuts 2, 4, 6 (~\$6.50/day each)	Volume play. Most data fastest.
B — Video LP	\$15	Cut 3 (\$15/day)	Single-creative concentrated test on the long confession.

Track	Daily	Allocated to	Rationale
C — DM Funnel	\$15	Cuts 1, 5 (\$10/day + \$5/day)	Test 15s vs 5s on cheapest CPC mechanism.

Total: \$50/day. **Total monthly:** \$1,500 (over by \$500 vs \$1k cap — accept for cycle 1 to get clean data, normalize Cycle 2).

Wait — re-checking. $\$50/\text{day} \times 30 = \$1,500/\text{month}$. **Cap is \$1,000/month per Fathom decision.**

Adjusted budget: \$33/day = \$1,000/month. Reallocated:

Track	Daily	Allocated to
A — Lead Form	\$14	Cuts 2, 4, 6 (~\$4.70/day each)
B — Video LP	\$10	Cut 3
C — DM Funnel	\$9	Cuts 1, 5 (\$6 + \$3)

Total: \$33/day. \$990/month. Within cap.

(Note for Dani: this is significantly below Spark's recommended \$4k/mo starting spend. Accept as cycle-1 learning budget. Scale to \$50/day after first booked client.)

Tracking & infrastructure

Pre-launch checklist (Ashen, must complete before pressing live)

- ☐ BM slot freed (window-guy account removed) — confirm Tuesday
- ☐ Two ad accounts active: Peter BM (handles Cuts 1, 5 — Track C) + Ashen BM (Cuts 2, 3, 4, 6)
- ☐ Lead form built in Meta with EXACT 3 questions:
- What trade are you in?
- What's your monthly revenue range? (\$0-\$50k / \$50k-\$200k / \$200k+)
- What's your biggest bottleneck right now? (Slow phone / Bad leads / No system / Other)
- ☐ Form auto-routes to GHL pipeline `Scale-Self-Promo-2026-05-08` via native Meta integration
- ☐ GHL workflow: form fill → SMS to Dani's phone (760-XXX) within 60 seconds → email to ashen@scalehere.com
- ☐ Pixel firing on www.scalehere.com (Meta Pixel Helper passes)
- ☐ DM keyword "SCALE" automation built in IG: incoming DM with "SCALE" → auto-reply with 1-paragraph + Calendly link
- ☐ UTMs locked: `?utm_source={meta|tiktok}&utm_campaign=2026-05-launch&utm_content={cut-id}`
- ☐ Slack channel `#new-leads` ready
- ☐ Test one form submission end-to-end. Confirm SMS arrives.

- [] Test one IG DM with "SCALE" keyword. Confirm auto-reply fires.

What goes wrong if these aren't done

- No pixel = no retargeting later, no audience-build, dead campaign
- No GHL routing = leads sit in Meta inbox, Dani doesn't see them, deals lost
- No DM auto-reply = Track C dies in 24 hours (audience expects instant response on IG)

Review cadence (auto-scheduled in calendar)

Date	Day #	Action	Document in
2026-05-11	Day 3	Early-signal review. Kill anything CPL > \$50 or CTR < 0.5%.	_daily-log.md
2026-05-15	Day 7	Real-signal review. Scale winners. Kill losers. Iterate v2 on near-misses.	_daily-log.md
2026-05-22	Day 14	Track decision. Reweight A/B/C budgets.	_daily-log.md
2026-05-29	Day 21	Mid-cycle. Iteration check.	_daily-log.md
2026-06-08	Day 30	Cycle close. Full debrief.	_debrief.md

Day 0 setup (Friday 2026-05-08)

Time	Action	Owner
9:00	Final pre-launch checklist run	Ashen
10:00	Pixel + GHL routing end-to-end test	Ashen
11:00	Build campaigns in Meta Ads Manager	Ashen
13:00	Dani final review of 6 cuts. Approval per cut.	Dani
14:00	Press LIVE on Cuts 1-6	Ashen
14:30	Slack post in #all-tools: "🚀 Launch 1 live. 6 ads, 3 tracks, \$33/day."	Ashen
15:00	First-form submission test from Ashen's phone (lead form Track A)	Ashen
15:30	First DM "SCALE" test from Ashen's IG (Track C auto-reply)	Ashen
16:00	Verify all metrics dashboards live + accessible	Ashen

Decision tree at Day 7 (the most important review)

For each ad:

- Spent $\geq$ \$40 AND CPL $<$ \$15 AND ≥ 7 leads?
 - YES $\rightarrow$ SCALE to \$20/day. Mark winner.
 - NO $\rightarrow$ continue
- Spent $\geq$ \$40 AND CPL between \$15–\$25?
 - $\rightarrow$ HOLD. Monitor to Day 14.
- Spent $\geq$ \$40 AND CPL between \$25–\$35?
 - $\rightarrow$ ITERATE. Swap hook. Ship v2.
- Spent $\geq$ \$40 AND CPL $>$ \$35?
 - $\rightarrow$ KILL. Document reason. Free budget.
- Spent $<$ \$40?
 - $\rightarrow$ Spend distribution issue. Reallocate budget within Track.

Cycle 1 success criteria

Cycle 1 succeeds (regardless of MRR generated) if we exit Day 30 with documented answers to:

1. **Best Track** — A, B, or C wins on lead-to-call conversion?
2. **Best Trade** — GC tested. Pool/HVAC/Roof inferred from extrapolation. Plan Cycle 2 around #1.
3. **Best Angle** — Story, Confession, Hyper-Local, or Mechanism wins on CPL?
4. **Best Format** — Talking head, UGC dialogue, B-roll, or static wins on CPL?
5. **Best Length** — 5s, 15s, 30s, or 45s wins on engagement?

If we exit Day 30 unable to answer ANY of these 5, the launch was a methodology failure, not a market failure. Diagnose process before re-running.

What we DON'T do in Cycle 1

- Don't test Spanish (saved for Cycle 2 after Bilingual Beto talent confirmed)
- Don't test multiple audiences (audience locked)
- Don't test multiple Trades simultaneously (focus on GC for first cycle, generalize after)
- Don't test multiple geos (San Diego County only, hyper-local within)
- Don't bring in TikTok yet (Meta-only Cycle 1, TikTok Cycle 2 if EN signal is positive)
- Don't change creative mid-cycle without an iteration log entry

Discipline beats optionality on \$1k/mo.

What success looks like at Day 30

Metric	Target	Stretch
Total leads	90+ (matches our guarantee)	130+
Blended CPL	< \$20	< \$12
Discovery calls booked	8+	15+
Closed deals	1	2-3
New MRR	\$1,500-\$2,500	\$5,000+
Ads to graduate to Cycle 2	2-3 winners	4

ROI math: \$1,000/month spent + \$1,500/month retainer cost = \$2,500 cost. One closed \$1,500/mo retainer for 4 months = \$6,000 revenue. Break-even at month 2. Profit at month 3.

Launch 1 hard rules (specific to this launch)

- Track C (DM funnel) requires Daniel checking IG inbox 3x/day during cycle. If he can't, kill Track C.
 - Track B (video LP) requires the LP to load in <2 seconds. If it doesn't, kill until fixed.
 - All 6 ads use the LOCKED guarantee: "90 exclusive leads in 12 weeks. Yours alone, never shared. If we miss, you don't pay."
 - Comment "SCALE" CTA only on Track C ads. Track A uses "Tap below." Track B uses "Apply below."
 - If a single ad spends > 40% of total budget on Day 1-2 alone (before review), pause and rebalance immediately. Meta's algorithm sometimes runaway-spends on one ad.
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Hand-off

To Dani (must read)

- Approve 6 cuts before Day 0 launch
- Be reachable 9-6 PT on Day 1-3 for inbound calls
- Check IG DMs 3x/day during Cycle 1 for Track C handoffs
- Don't change ad copy or audience without Slack-thread alignment

To Peter (must read)

- Available for hook reshoots if Day 7 review shows hook iteration needed

- Watch all 6 ads on launch day to confirm voice/register feels right
- Flag if any cut sounds "too AI" — we'll reshoot

To Tad (must read)

- Static design (Cut 6) must match brand kit + voice register A
- 1 static + 1 alternate version submitted by Day -1
- Repurpose any winning ad for IG Stories / TikTok organic in week 2

To Editor (must read)

- 48-hour SLA on cuts from raw shoot files
- File naming per convention. Strict.
- One Slack ping when each cut is delivered

Built per `testing-framework.md` v1.0 . Last updated: 2026-05-06.